

10.6.6 Problem Reports And Solutions

When a program fails under Vista, a report is generated by the system's tools. This particular report is usually sent to Microsoft for analysis and tracking—for example, if your video player crashes while playing a video file, the report and solutions tool will log all the details surrounding the crash. This report is then automatically sent to Microsoft and might come back with a solution such as “upgrade your software,” or “no solution currently available.” While most of this process is automated, you can see the details of these reports if you wish from the Control Panel: choose System and Maintenance, and click Problem Reports and Solutions. From the Tasks menu, you can view your history of problem diagnosis attempts, re-run a check for a problem, and even see the details of one of your problem reports.



Problem Reports is like XP's Error Reporting

If you don't want Vista to automatically check for solutions, you can disable this functionality: click Change Settings under the Tasks menu to do so.

10.6.7 Reliability Monitor

The Reliability Monitor is an extremely useful and comprehensive diagnostic tool. It essentially tracks various subsystems of the operating system and keeps a log of all the failures and success—it is very useful for a variety of things: from diagnosing a particular subsystem, to keeping tab on the overall “reliability” of the system and rates the stability of the system using a reliability index. The tool tracks hardware failures, operating system failures, application failures, and other events that may indicate problems with the stability of your machine. You can filter the display to show all